

SKILLS GUIDE



Good numerical skills to interpret plans and designs and take accurate measurements on site.



Strong team-working skills for collaborating with fellow construction staff.



The flexibility to adapt to new projects and to travel to work at different building sites.



Physical fitness and resilience to perform manual work in a range of weather conditions.



Manual dexterity for using hand tools and construction machinery safely and efficiently.



BUILDING CONTRACTOR

Oversees a project for a building firm, hiring, managing, and coordinating the required construction workers and equipment to complete the job.



SITE SUPERVISOR Manages the day-to-day activities of the bricklayers, electricians, carpenters, and other tradespeople on the building site.



STONE MASON Specializes in restoring and creating stonework and decorative features. Masons work on new as well as historic buildings.



BUILDING TECHNICIAN Estimates building costs, negotiates the purchase of materials, ensures quality standards are maintained, and supervises contractors on site.

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Construction • Design technology • Technical drawing • Mathematics • English • Physical education



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS There are no formal entry requirements. Most entrants learn their trade skills at college or as building apprentices.



LIFESTYLE Most builders work regular hours. Evening and weekend work may be required to complete a project or to make the most of favorable conditions.



LOCATION Builders usually work on construction sites or in buildings. Some travel is required; overnight stays are likely if sites are far from home.



THE REALITIES The work is physically demanding and requires strength, agility, and resilience for working in poor weather or challenging conditions.

RELATED CAREERS

► **CIVIL ENGINEER** *see pp. 176–177*

► **CARPENTER** *see pp. 206–207*

► **ELECTRICIAN** *see pp. 208–209*

► **PLUMBER** *see pp. 210–211*

► **SCAFFOLDER** Constructs scaffolding poles, platforms, and ladders to enable builders to access high-level exterior areas of a building. Scaffolders are also trained to use ropes and climbing equipment to reach inaccessible areas.